

Unit 1: Introduction to Technical Writing

1. What is Technical Writing?

Technical writing is the art of translating complex, specialized concepts into clear, accessible communication. Its primary objective is to convey technical information to an individual or audience so that it can be easily understood and acted upon.

At its core, technical writing is deeply **audience-centered**. Writers take high-level, intricate knowledge and adapt it specifically for their readers—whether those readers are subject-matter experts or non-technical users. To achieve this, technical writing relies on a clear, direct, and neutral tone, deliberately avoiding jargon, fluff, or overly flowery language.

Modern technical communication leverages digital tools—including web pages, user documentation, and digital media—to distribute information effectively across engineering, healthcare, software, finance, manufacturing, and consulting.

Common Examples of Technical Writing

- **Documentation:** User manuals, policy guides, process documentation, and step-by-step instructions.
- **Business Communication:** Proposals, reports, summaries, memos, and professional emails.
- **Career & Digital Assets:** Resumes, application letters, and web content.

2. You Are Already a Technical Writer

Every individual has engaged in technical communication at some point. Practical everyday scenarios demonstrate that technical writing is simply the clear transmission of functional information:

- Drawing a map or process diagram for a friend
- Giving spoken directions to a specific location
- Providing step-by-step instructions for tasks like preparing a recipe, repairing a bicycle tire, or administering CPR

Key Takeaway: If you have ever structured complex instructions to help someone accomplish a specific task, you have already practiced technical writing.

3. Characteristics of Technical Writing

Technical writing is defined by six core structural and linguistic conventions:

Characteristic	Description
Subject Matter	Fact-based and research-driven. Content relies strictly on empirical data, scientific observation, and primary research rather than opinion or speculation.

Audience Orientation	User-centered and action-oriented. Tailored to the reader's background knowledge to help them execute specific tasks (e.g., troubleshooting equipment, installing software).
Organization	Systematically structured and scannable. Follows a logical hierarchy using headings, subheadings, and formatting to navigate and retrieve information instantly.
Style	Direct, precise, and unvarnished. Sentences are concise, grammatically clear, and logically ordered while avoiding ambiguous or decorative language.
Tone	Objective, neutral, and professional. Maintains an impartial, matter-of-fact stance, completely excluding personal feelings, subjective commentary, or emotional bias.
Special Features	Visually supported. Integrates typography, structural layouts, and graphics like tables, charts, and diagrams to emphasize key data and streamline comprehension.

4. Comparing Technical Writing to Other Forms

While technical writing shares some elements with other forms of composition, it remains distinct in its purpose, audience, and execution.

A. Technical Writing vs. Academic Writing

Shared Elements

- Both are practiced and taught within academic institutions.
- Both employ formal, standard language with coherent, well-organized structures.
- Both function primarily as expository writing designed to inform, explain, or persuade using standard paragraph composition.

Key Differences

Feature	Academic Writing	Technical Writing
Formatting	Continuous prose blocks with standard citation styles (APA, MLA).	Heavy structural visual design (headings, bullet points, callout boxes, visual tables).
Audience	Educational demographic (instructors, classmates, peer scholars).	Specific end-users across both technical and non-technical domains.

Primary Objective	To expand, explore, and analyze an idea in depth.	To clarify and simplify an idea for immediate practical application.
Subject Matter	Broad topics ranging from literature to philosophy and personal essays.	Specialized, task-oriented subjects and real-world systems.

B. Technical Writing vs. Personal Writing

- **Subjectivity vs. Objectivity:** Personal writing expresses internal feelings, emotions, and subjective experiences (joy, grief, humor). Technical writing is strictly objective and leaves no room for personal commentary.
- **Style and Tone:** Personal writing uses a conversational tone to connect with or entertain the reader. Technical writing uses a neutral, business-like tone to convey factual data quickly.
- **Reader Expectations:** Readers approach personal writing for engagement or entertainment. Readers approach technical writing solely to extract specific information or complete a task.

C. Technical Writing vs. Imaginative Writing

- **Origin and Subject:** Imaginative writing (fiction, poetry, drama) stems from creative invention, featuring artistic elements, fictional characters, and abstract themes. Technical writing deals exclusively with real-world, factual processes and systems.
- **Interpretation vs. Precision:** Imaginative writing uses symbolism and open-ended phrasing, encouraging multiple subjective interpretations. Technical writing demands complete clarity with zero ambiguity.

As **W. Earl Britton** famously noted, technical writing requires that a statement conveys one, and only one, possible meaning to prevent misinterpretation:

- **Ambiguous:** *"Turn there."* (Unclear; leaves the reader guessing whether to turn left or right).
- **Direct:** *"Turn left at the crossroad."* (Unambiguous; provides precise, actionable direction)

Unit 2: Audience and Purpose

1. Meeting the Audience's Needs

Audience refers to the specific individuals or groups for whom a technical document is written. Unlike creative writing, where an author may write without a designated reader in mind, technical communication requires analyzing the target audience before drafting begins.

Golden Rule of Technical Writing: Analyze your audience. Their needs and wants decide every decision you make—from the words you choose to the format you deliver.

Audience Types: Specific vs. Multiple

- **Specific Audience:** An audience with a common purpose and a shared point of view.
- **Multiple Audience:** Readers with several distinct purposes, backgrounds, and points of view.

Gathering Demographic Data

To effectively write for an audience, you must gather demographic information such as age, experience, gender, income, and educational level.

- **Example:** If advertising a new day-care center, your audience consists of working or single parents with young children. Census data helps identify where this audience lives and where to place advertisements.

2. Audience Categories & Reader Types

A. High-Level Categories

Category	Target Audience	Knowledge Level & Language Needs
Technical	Subject-matter experts, engineers, physicians	Possesses specialized knowledge; understands complex domain terminology without requiring explicit definitions.
Semi-Technical	Administrative staff, marketing specialists	Possesses foundational knowledge; understands basic concepts but requires explanations for complex terminology.
Non-Technical	General public, executive management	Requires straightforward, accessible language completely free of specialized jargon.

B. Specific Reader Types

When planning a document, consider which specific role your reader fulfills:

- **Lay Reader:** A general reader without specialized knowledge who is interested in the subject.
 - **Focus:** Wants clear, accessible information.
 - **Examples:** Readers of general tech magazines or news articles.
- **Technician:** A hands-on operator with skilled practical knowledge who implements ideas in the field.
 - **Focus:** Operates equipment, repairs machinery, and trains others.
 - **Examples:** Uses manuals, schematics, blueprints, and technical reports.
- **Expert:** A highly skilled professional who designs equipment, conducts research, and creates new products.
 - **Focus:** Deep technical accuracy and theory.
 - **Examples:** Medical doctors, engineers; reads and writes for professional journals.
- **Manager:** An organizational leader responsible for personnel and day-to-day operations.
 - **Focus:** Strategic vision, operational problem-solving, long-term planning, and moving the organization forward.

3. Factors for Analyzing Your Audience

Once you identify your audience, evaluate them across five critical factors:

Factor	Description	Strategic Application
1. Knowledge Level	Baseline understanding (high, low, or moderate).	Find out what they already know, what they need to know, and what they lack. Telling readers what they know wastes time; omitting what they need leads to critical errors.
2. Reader Role	The job, function, or responsibility the reader performs at work.	Tailor content to their function. A memo to an accountant focuses on costs; a memo to a technician focuses on operational mechanics.
3. Interest	Level of engagement with the topic.	If high, provide thorough details. If low, attempt to motivate them or deliver strictly essential information. Note: Interests shift with age, role, and experience.

4. Cultural Background	Cultural norms and communication styles.	Adapt tone to avoid offense or miscommunication. e.g., American business meetings jump straight to business, whereas other cultures require informal rapport first.
5. Personality	Individual traits (introvert vs. extrovert, high-detail vs. high-level summary).	Dictates communication medium and style. Introverts may prefer written emails; extroverts may prefer group discussions.

4. Meeting the Needs of a Multiple Audience

When writing for a complex group (e.g., executives, managers, and administrative assistants at the same time), you must structure the document to satisfy everyone's needs simultaneously.

Strategy 1: Modular Document Structure

Break the document into clear sections using distinct headings and sub-headings so different readers can quickly navigate to the specific sections relevant to them.

Strategy 2: Prioritizing Primary vs. Secondary Audiences

Audience Level	Target Group	Focus & Role
Primary Audience	Decision-Makers / Core	Key stakeholders who make final choices, approve proposals, or take direct action based on the document.
Secondary Audience	Implementers / Staff	Operations staff and technical teams who carry out the decisions, enforce guidelines, or maintain systems.

Case Study (Feasibility Report)

When writing a feasibility report for establishing an international facility:

- **Primary Audience:** Company executives and legal counsel (they evaluate the report to decide whether to build).
- **Secondary Audience:** Architects (to design the plant), sales managers (to move workers), and department heads (to train staff).

5. Planning Document Purpose, Scope, and Medium

Before writing, establish the document's framework by defining its purpose, scope, and delivery medium.

A. Purpose

The purpose is the specific outcome you want to achieve—what you want the reader to know, learn, or do after reading. Technical documents are both informative and persuasive.

Questions to Determine Purpose:

- What do I want to inform my readers about?
- What do I want to convince/persuade them to do?
- What action should happen after they read this?

Examples of Purpose Statements:

- *"To inform citizens of the latest employment trends."*
- *"To convince the public to purchase smoke alarms."*
- *"To persuade bank customers to invest in money market accounts."*

B. Scope

Scope defines what information to include, what to omit, and how much detail to provide.

- **Example (Changing a Tire):** The primary purpose is enabling the reader to change a flat tire. The scope includes instructions on jacking up the car and loosening lug nuts, but might omit long-term tire rotation maintenance depending on user goals.

C. Medium and Format

The medium is the vehicle used to convey your message (e.g., email, memo, web page, print brochure, slide deck, manual).

Factors for Selecting a Medium:

- **Appropriateness:** Cost, age of the audience, production lead time, and reader convenience (e.g., print vs. laptop screen).
- **Organizational Culture:** Standard practices within your workplace (e.g., internal memos vs. emails).
- **Format & Style Guides:** Required structural rules and citation styles (such as APA, MLA, or Chicago Manual Style).

Unit 3: Writing Process

1. Introduction

The technical writing process is a multi-step journey that rarely moves forward in a straight line. By nature, writing is a **recursive, circular process** that moves back and forth between stages as ideas develop and require refining.

Writing Stage	Core Activity	Purpose & Focus
1. Planning	Concept & Research	Brainstorming topics, defining target audiences, and mapping initial content structures.
2. Drafting	Content Generation	Translating research and structured outlines into continuous sentences and paragraphs.
3. Revising	Structural Evaluation	Re-evaluating argument flow, section organization, completeness, and clarity.
4. Copyediting	Surface Mechanics	Fixing grammatical issues, punctuation errors, spelling, and style consistency.
5. Publishing	Delivery	Preparing final visual layouts and distributing the document to its audience.

Stages of the Technical Writing ProcessKey Considerations of the Process

- **Time Commitment:** Writing requires sufficient time to collect data through research and allow ideas to formulate ("cook") in the mind.
- **Individual Variation:** Preferences vary among writers—some excel at early planning and pre-writing, while others prefer revising and polishing rough drafts.

2. Target Audience Hierarchy

Understanding your audience is critical during the planning stage. Technical documents often serve multiple layers of readers with different operational needs.

Audience Breakdown

Audience Level	Target Group	Focus & Role
Primary Audience	Decision-Makers / Core	Key stakeholders who evaluate high-level choices, fund projects, or approve proposals based on the document.
Secondary Audience	Implementers / Staff	Technical teams, engineers, and support staff who carry out the decisions, enforce guidelines, or maintain systems.

Audience Descriptions

- **Primary Audience (Decision-Makers / Core):** The primary group for whom the document is written. They rely on executive summaries, cost-benefit analyses, and high-level outcomes to make informed organizational decisions.
- **Secondary Audience (Implementers / Staff):** Supporting readers who receive the document after an action or policy is approved. They need detailed technical steps, specifications, and procedures to execute the directives effectively.

3. Stages of Technical Writing

Stage 1: Planning

Planning is the foundational stage where a writer conceptualizes a project and prepares to research and organize ideas.

A. Choosing a Topic

Topics are either assigned by an instructor/employer or self-selected. When choosing a topic independently, writers use two primary strategies:

- **Freewriting:** Writing continuously without worrying about grammar, punctuation, or sentence structure.
 - **Open Freewriting:** Unrestricted writing on any subject to discover unexpected ideas.
 - **Focused Freewriting:** Writing freely while associating ideas around a specific starting topic.

- **Looping:** Writing for a set period, stopping to summarize the core idea into a single sentence, and using that summary as the prompt for the next loop.
- **Journaling:** Maintaining a regular diary or journal to log important thoughts, insights, and potential technical topics as they occur naturally.

B. Shaping an Idea

Once selected, an idea must be given structure and direction by addressing:

- **Scope:** Is the idea narrow enough to maintain focus?
- **Development:** How will the concept be supported?
- **Subtopics:** What are the core components?
- **Organization:** How will those components be logically ordered?

Four Strategies for Shaping Ideas:

1. **Questioning:** Asking audience-centric questions (*Who benefits? What do they need to know? Where/when will they use this?*).
2. **Reading:** Reviewing personal journals or source materials to extract directional focus.
3. **Mapping:** Using visual clusters, outlines, and category groupings to establish relationships between major themes and subtopics while filtering out irrelevant data.
4. **Outlining:** Converting visual maps into structured hierarchies using headings, subheadings, and bullet points.

Common Information Structure Patterns:

- General $\rightarrow$ Specific
- Familiar $\rightarrow$ Less Familiar
- Important $\rightarrow$ Less Important
- Background $\rightarrow$ New Information
- Simple $\rightarrow$ Complex

Stage 2: Drafting

Drafting transforms organized ideas into complete prose. A draft is an evolving, preliminary version of a document.

Drafting Principle: Focus on getting ideas down on paper without stopping to correct grammar or search for the "perfect" opening sentence.

Structural Parts of a Technical Document

Document Section	Core Purpose	Key Elements
1. Introduction	Captures attention and sets expectations.	• Forecasts topic & scope • States thesis/main idea • Identifies problem & research background

2. Body	Supports the main thesis with evidence.	• Examples & case studies • Statistics & financial estimates • Testimonials & expert quotes
3. Conclusion	Provides a logical resolution based on document type.	• Proposal: Presents the solution • Sales Letter: Requests specific action • Research Paper: Answers core questions

Stage 3: Revising

Revising is the critical act of reading a draft to re-evaluate content, structure, and overall flow. Writers modify, add, delete, and rearrange text to improve clarity, coherence, and audience alignment.

Revision Checklist

Focus Area	Key Questions to Ask Yourself	Description
Content	• Is there enough or too much information? • Do I need more research or to cut filler? • Is the introduction effective and scope clear?	Evaluates whether the document thoroughly answers the core problem without overwhelming the reader with irrelevant details.

Organization	• Is information ordered logically? • Does every paragraph have a topic sentence? • Are section transitions smooth?	Ensures logical transitions between ideas so readers can follow arguments easily across sections.
Readability	• Does the writing flow smoothly? • Are sentence lengths varied? • Are specialized terms defined clearly?	Focuses on clarity, concise phrasing, and making complex terms accessible to non-expert audiences.

Stage 4: Copyediting

Copyediting (proofreading) focuses on surface-level precision, grammar, mechanics, and formatting.

Proofreading Techniques

- **Read Aloud:** Forces the writer to slow down and catch unnatural phrasing or missing words.
- **Read Backward:** Reading sentence-by-sentence from the end of the document to the beginning isolates mechanical errors from context.
- **Peer Review:** Having a colleague review the draft catches blind spots that the primary writer might overlook.
- **Electronic Aids:** Utilizing spell-checkers, grammar checkers, online dictionaries, and thesauruses.

Warning on Automated Tools: Spell-checkers miss homophones (*there* vs. *their*), and grammar checkers may misinterpret domain-specific phrasing. Human oversight is mandatory.

Key Copyediting Questions:

- Are there sentence structure errors (fragments, run-ons, comma splices)?
- Is punctuation used correctly?
- Are all words spelled accurately?
- Is there redundant language or unnecessary fluff?
- Are all sources properly cited?

Stage 5: Publishing

Publishing is the delivery of the finalized, polished document to its intended audience in the requested format.

Pre-Publishing Checklist

- **Appearance:** High-quality print/digital layout with clean formatting.
- **Timeliness:** Document prepared ahead of schedule to absorb unexpected equipment/technical delays.
- **Audience Format:** Delivered in the specific medium requested by stakeholders.
- **Citations:** Source attribution verified for accuracy.

4. Writing Collaboratively

Collaborative writing involves multiple professionals working together to produce a single document (e.g., reports, proposals, user guides, research papers).

Team Roles & Responsibilities

Team Role	Key Responsibility	Description
Subject Experts / Researchers	Data & Fact Verification	Gather empirical data, execute domain research, and verify technical accuracy.
Draft Writers	Content Generation	Synthesize technical data and research into structured prose and paragraphs.
Graphic / Layout Designers	Visual Formatting	Design visual tools, charts, data tables, and maintain document typography.
Lead Editor	Quality & Consistency	Oversees compilation, unifies tone/style across authors, and performs copyediting.

Advantages vs. Disadvantages of Collaborative Writing

Advantages	Disadvantages
Combined Expertise: Pulls specialized knowledge from multiple domains.	Groupthink: Members may agree passively without critical evaluation.

Diverse Perspectives: Highlights different viewpoints to refine arguments.	Conflict: Disagreements over style, content, or direction.
Task Distribution: Shared workload makes complex projects manageable.	Unequal Workloads: Some members may contribute more than others.
Improved Relationships: Builds teamwork, communication, and trust.	Fragmented Style: Risk of inconsistent tone or disjointed structure.
Talent Synergy: Pairs strong researchers with strong writers/designers.	Extended Timeline: Scheduling reviews and meetings takes longer.

Organizational Models for Collaborative Writing

- **Section Writers with One Editor:** Team members write separate sections; a single lead editor compiles, unifies, and polishes the document.
- **Data Contributors with One Writer:** Members gather research and submit data to a primary writer who crafts the entire draft for team review.
- **Stage-Based Division:** Different members own specific stages (e.g., Person A researches $\rightarrow$ Person B drafts $\rightarrow$ Person C revises $\rightarrow$ Person D copyedits).
- **Joint Writing:** Team members divide research tasks independently and then sit down together (in-person or virtually) to write and discuss synchronously.

Team Dynamics: Trust & Professional Work Habits

Core Pillars of Team Trust

- **Be Responsible:** Keep commitments and honor assigned deadlines.
- **Be Loyal:** Support the team and address internal friction privately within the group.
- **Be Honest:** Attribute data sources accurately and communicate progress candidly.
- **Be Respectful:** Value differing perspectives, practice basic courtesy, and acknowledge contributions.
- **Be Fair:** Pull an equal weight without taking unearned credit for others' work.

Essential Work Habits for Group Members

- **Complete Assigned Tasks:** Fulfill your specific section on time.
- **Arrive Prepared:** Review meeting agendas and prepare suggestions in advance.
- **Engage Positively:** Show interest and deliver constructive feedback.
- **Maintain Punctuality:** Attend meetings on time or give advance notice of delays.
- **Separate Ideas from Identity:** View critique as a tool for document quality, not personal criticism.

Unit 4: Brief Correspondences

1. Introduction to Modes of Communication

Brief correspondences serve as the primary drivers of daily organizational communication. Depending on the audience, channel, and purpose, messages range from informal digital notes to strict, formal legal records.

A. Text Messaging (SMS)

SMS stands for **Short Message Service**. It is used to send and receive short, urgent messages via mobile devices and has become increasingly popular for rapid business communication.

- **Speed & Reach:** It is the fastest means of written communication, allowing messages and responses to be exchanged almost instantaneously.
- **Formality:** Primarily informal, but can adapt to formal contexts depending on the recipient, topic, style, and tone.
- **Applications:** Widely used in direct marketing and operational updates (e.g., notifying clients about products, flash sales, flight schedules, appointment reminders, and meeting changes).

Example SMS (Business Informational):

"Dear Customer, your appointment with Apex Health is confirmed for tomorrow, Oct 12, at 10:00 AM. Reply '1' to confirm or '2' to reschedule."

B. Emails

Email is a global, electronic standard for written communication, favored for its speed, accessibility, and record-keeping capability.

- **Formality:** Flexible. It ranges from informal internal notes to highly formal external proposals depending on context (*who sends what to whom, when, and how*).
- **Advantages:** Fast, low-cost, and easily archivable.
- **Disadvantages:** High volume can lead to messages being ignored, flagged as spam, or accidentally deleted.

Example Email (Workplace Inquiry):

To: s.shrestha@company.com

Subject: Inquiry: Q3 Financial Summary Report

Dear Mr. Shrestha,

I hope this email finds you well. Could you please send over the finalized Q3 financial summary report by 3:00 PM today? We need to review the metrics before the board meeting tomorrow morning.

Thank you,

Aayush Sharma | Project Lead

C. Memos (Memoranda)

A **memo** (plural: *memos* or *memoranda*) is an informal, internal document used to exchange information between individuals, departments, or divisions within the same organization.

- **Scope:** Used strictly for internal ("in-house") communication.
- **Structure:** Written like short internal letters, but **do not** require street addresses, formal salutations (greetings), or formal sign-offs (complimentary closes).
- **Length:** Varies from a single sentence ("*Please order more printing paper.*") to multi-page internal operational reports.
- **Purpose:** Efficiently distributes information to large internal groups while leaving an official paper trail.

Example Memo Structure:

DATE: 5 Baisakh 2080

TO: Personnel Manager

FROM: Production Manager

SUBJECT: Change in Working Hours

With reference to your memo dated 3 Baisakh 2080 regarding a change in working hours for your department due to heatwave conditions, management has approved the requested schedule adjustment.

The new operational schedule will be from 6:00 AM to 11:00 AM, effective from 7 Baisakh 2080.

Kindly inform all employees within your department.

Thank you,

(Signature)

Production Manager

D. Letters

Letters represent the most formal vehicle for business correspondence. They are longer, more structured, and carry more official weight than memos, emails, or text messages.

- **Audience:** Written primarily to external readers (clients, suppliers, government bodies), though occasionally sent internally for official legal or HR matters (e.g., termination, promotion).
- **Characteristics:** Highly structured, polite, precise, and professional. Avoids conversational slang, clichés, or overly familiar phrasing.
- **Purpose:** Establishes and maintains formal business relationships while providing a verifiable written record.
- **Disadvantages:** Slower delivery times and risk of non-delivery via physical postal services.

Structural Layouts of Business Letters

1. Complete Block Letter Style

- All elements align strictly against the **left margin**.
- The only exception is a pre-printed corporate **letterhead**, centered at the top.

- Paragraphs are **not indented**; double spacing is used between paragraphs.

Layout Preview (Complete Block):

[LETTERHEAD]
Date: June 9, 2026
Inside Address: Mr. Ram Bahadur Chhetri, Head, Dept. of CS
Subject: Equipment Quotation
Salutation: Dear Mr. Chhetri:
Body Paragraph 1 (Aligned left, no indent)...
Body Paragraph 2 (Aligned left, no indent)...
Complimentary Close: Sincerely yours,
Signature Block: [Signature]

2. Modified Block Letter Style

- The **dateline**, **complimentary close**, and **signature block** begin at the **horizontal center** (aligned toward the right margin).
- The first line of each paragraph is **indented**.

Punctuation Styles in Business Letters

Punctuation Style	Rules & Features	Formatting Pairings	Example
Open Punctuation	No punctuation marks are placed after the Salutation or the Complimentary Close. Modern and time-saving.	Standard in Complete Block Style.	Dear Sir Sincerely yours
Mixed Punctuation	Uses a colon (:) or comma (,) after the Salutation and a comma (,) after the Complimentary Close.	Standard in Modified Block Style.	Dear Sir: or Dear Sir, Sincerely,

2. Audience Analysis for Correspondence

Understanding who will read your document dictates the level of formality, structural tone, depth of detail, and choice of medium.

Audience Breakdown

Channel	Target Audience	Formality Level	Audience Considerations

SMS / Texting	Internal team members or external opt-in clients.	Informal to Semi-Formal	High urgency; reader expects immediate, concise action items.
Email	Both Internal (colleagues) and External (clients/partners).	Semi-Formal to Formal	Context must be explicit; reader may receive high daily email volumes.
Memos	Strictly Internal (staff, supervisors, divisions).	Semi-Formal	Shared institutional context; focus on clear operational directives.
Letters	Primarily External (clients, authorities, public).	Strictly Formal	High impact on institutional reputation; requires complete background detail and diplomatic tone.

3. Prewriting and Planning Strategies

A. Planning SMS and Emails

- **Write Clear Subject Lines:** Busy professionals filter messages using subject lines. Make them specific and descriptive.
- **Maintain Formality:** Write complete sentences, use correct punctuation, and avoid obscure abbreviations or slang even with internal colleagues.
- **Be Concise:** Keep content short and focused on one core request or update.
- **Limit Complex Formatting:** Avoid intricate tables or decorative styles that may render poorly across different mobile screens or email clients.
- **Establish Clear Context:** Always state upfront if you are referencing a previous meeting, email thread, or phone call.

Do's and Don'ts for SMS & Email Communication

Category	Do	Don't
Responsiveness	Read and reply promptly. Send a quick confirmation if a full response requires extra research time.	Do not leave critical business inquiries unanswered for extended periods.
Tone & Style	State the context clearly and choose words carefully, as physical body language is absent.	Do not write while angry or emotional. Do not write content you wouldn't state publicly.
Typography	Use standard sentence casing and standard mechanics.	DO NOT TYPE IN ALL CAPS (interpreted as shouting) or all lowercase (looks lazy/unprofessional).
Content Scope	Keep paragraphs focused and highlight actionable deadlines.	Do not include offensive, illegal, or irrelevant long blocks of quoted text.

B. Planning Memos

1. **Single-Topic Focus:** Restrict each memo to one distinct operational subject to ensure clarity and easy filing.
2. **Conciseness with Completeness:** Keep the text brief, but verify that essential details (dates, times, locations, contact points) are included.
3. **Structured Formality:** Use standard grammar, full sentences, clear headings, and minimal abbreviations

C. Planning Letters

1. **Comprehensive Information:** Include every necessary section (Letterhead, Inside Address, Signature) and provide full contextual background. External readers may not know your internal operations.
2. **Professional Language:**
 - Avoid informal contractions (*don't*, *won't*, *can't*).

- Avoid conversational clichés and emotional commentary.
 - Avoid or clearly define technical jargon.
3. **Internal HR Exceptions:** When writing internal letters regarding sensitive matters (e.g., disciplinary actions, terminations, official recommendations), maintain a strict formal tone.

4. Detailed Formatting Guidelines

A. Memo Format & Structure

Memos use a standard header block (**TO:**, **FROM:**, **DATE:**, **SUBJECT:**).

- **TO: Line Options:**
 - *Single Person:* **To: Amala Poudel, Finance Director**
 - *Multiple Individuals:* **To: Narendra Bahadur Chhetri, Gamala Thapa, Amala Poudel**
 - *Group/Department:* **To: The IT Division Supervisors**
- **FROM: Line Options:** Identifies the author or team issuing the memo. When multiple authors are listed, order them by hierarchy or alphabetically.
- **DATE: Line Options:**
 - *International/British Style:* **9 June 2026**
 - *Traditional/American Style:* **June 9, 2026**
- **SUBJECT: Line Options:** Can be written as **Subject:**, **Regarding:**, **Reference:**, or **Re:**. Must be a short descriptive phrase, **not** a full sentence.

B. The 12 Structural Elements of a Formal Business Letter

1. **Letterhead / Heading:** Pre-printed company header at top center. If absent, type the sender's address at the top-left margin (*Heading*).
2. **Dateline:** The exact date the letter is issued (e.g., **June 9, 2026** or **9 June 2026**).
3. **Inside Address (Superscription):** Name, professional title, organization, and full address of the recipient.
4. **Subject Line (Optional):** Summarizes the main purpose of the letter in a single line.
5. **Salutation (Greeting):** Formal opening line followed by a comma or colon (e.g., **Dear Mr. Chhetri:**, **Dear Sir or Madam:**).
6. **The Body:** The primary content of the letter. Always state the core point in the opening paragraph. Use subheadings for multi-page letters.
7. **Complimentary Close:** A polite, formal sign-off phrase (e.g., **Sincerely,**, **Cordially,**, **Respectfully,**).
8. **Signature Block:** Includes the author's handwritten signature, printed name, and professional title.
9. **Postscript (P.S.):** Used to add a critical afterthought or secondary emphasis after the signature block.

10. **Enclosure (Encl.):** Notes any supplemental documents attached in the envelope (e.g., **Encl: 1. Resume, 2. Academic Transcripts**).
11. **Carbon Copy / Courtesy Copy (CC):** Discloses other parties receiving a copy of the letter (e.g., **CC: Head, Dept. of English**).
12. **References (Optional):** A list of professional contacts provided for background checks (requires prior consent from the listed individuals).

5. Composing Strategies by Message Purpose

1. Informative & Good News Messages (Direct Approach)

- **Strategy:** Use the **direct approach**. Deliver the main positive point immediately in the first sentence, as the reader is receptive.
- **Structure:** Main News $\rightarrow$ Necessary Supporting Details $\rightarrow$ Warm, Future-Oriented Closing.

Example (Good News Email):

Subject: Approved: Equipment Upgrade Request

Dear Engineering Team,

We are pleased to inform you that your request for workstation graphics processor upgrades has been fully approved.

The new hardware units are scheduled for delivery on Monday, May 15. The IT Support team will perform the installations between 8:00 AM and 11:00 AM.

Thank you for your patience as we upgrade our development infrastructure.

Best regards,

Operations Team

2. Bad News Messages (Indirect Approach)

- **Strategy:** Use the **indirect approach**. Readers do not expect negative news; opening with a blunt refusal can cause defensive or hostile reactions.
- **Structure:**
 1. **Buffer:** A neutral or positive opening statement relevant to the topic.
 2. **Explanation:** Transparent, objective reasons justifying the decision.
 3. **Bad News Statement:** Delivered clearly, gently, and without emotional language.
 4. **Alternative/Solution:** Offer an alternative or constructive next step where possible.
 5. **Positive Close:** A warm, neutral, forward-looking sign-off.

Example (Bad News Letter):

Dear Mr. Sharma,

Thank you for submitting your application for the Senior Systems Architect position at our firm.

We appreciate the time you invested in interviewing with our team.

We received a high volume of applications from exceptionally qualified candidates. While your technical background in game systems is impressive, we have selected a candidate whose background more closely matches our immediate network infrastructure requirements.

We will keep your resume in our talent database for future roles that align with your experience. We wish you continued success in your professional endeavors.

Sincerely,

Human Resources Department

3. Persuasive Messages (Hook-Convince-Motivate)

- **Strategy:** Readers are often indifferent or resistant. Use an engaging framework to capture attention before making a request.
- **Structure:**
 1. **Hook (Attention):** Capture interest using a relevant question, compelling statistic, or shared challenge.
 2. **Convince (Interest/Desire):** Detail the benefits, provide factual evidence, share data, or reference expert testimonials.
 3. **Motivate (Action):** Direct the reader to take a clear, immediate action.

Example (Persuasive Email):

Subject: Reduce Your Build Compilation Times by 40%

Dear Lead Developer,

Are long asset compilation pipelines slowing down your daily sprint deployments?

Our automated build optimization tool integrates directly into existing CI/CD pipelines, cutting package export times in half. Teams utilizing our engine report saving an average of 12 developer-hours per week on continuous integration tasks.

Visit our portal today at developer.example.com to start your free 30-day sandbox trial!

Unit 5: Document Design and Graphics

1. Introduction

A picture is often worth a thousand words. Graphics are visual representations of information and data. The primary types of graphics used in technical writing include **photographs, pictures, line graphs, bar graphs, line drawings, tables, charts, and diagrams.**

Purposes of Using Graphics

- **To communicate visually:** Deliver complex data quickly and clearly.
- **To clarify ideas and concepts:** Simplify technical mechanisms or theoretical models.
- **To organize data:** Group related facts and figures for comparison.
- **To emphasize key points:** Highlight critical warnings, trends, or results.

Labeling Rule: Every graphic in a technical document must be labeled with a number and a descriptive title. All graphics are referred to as a **"Figure"** (e.g., *Figure 1: System Architecture*), except for tables, which are referred to as a **"Table"** (e.g., *Table 1: Performance Metrics*).

2. Designing the Document

Technical documents must be **visually friendly** and deliberately structured. Avoid crowding pages with too much dense text, as uncluttered designs help prevent reader confusion.

The Five Design Elements

Design Element	Guidelines and Best Practices
1. White Space	Blank areas surrounding text blocks. Maintain generous margins, space between paragraphs/columns, and padding around graphics and lists to improve scannability.
2. Text	Printed words on the page. Use left-aligned text with a ragged (uneven) right margin. Use readable Serif fonts (10–12 pt) for body text. Reserved ALL-CAPS for major titles or short emphasis—never full paragraphs.
3. Headings	Short labels that introduce sections and create a visual hierarchy. Prefer Arabic numerals (1, 2, 3) over Roman numerals (i, ii, iii). Size, bolding, and positioning establish structural importance.

4. Graphics	Visual representations of data integrated adjacent to their text references. Must always include a descriptive caption and figure number.
5. Medium	The delivery format (e.g., print brochure, web page, email, PDF). Choose the medium based on audience accessibility and communication purpose.

3. Who Reads Graphics?

Technical audiences (engineers, scientists, analysts, managers) rely heavily on graphics to extract precise meaning quickly. Complex subjects—such as IT, engineering, medicine, and quantitative marketing—are significantly easier to understand when paired with visual data.

Assessing Your Audience

Before selecting or constructing a graphic, evaluate your target readers:

- *How much background knowledge does the audience have on the subject?*
- *How interested is the audience in raw technical details versus high-level takeaways?*
- *Is the reading level of the audience basic, intermediate, or advanced?*

Purpose and Objectives

Purpose of Graphic	Recommended Graphic Type
To present a step-by-step process	Flowchart
To show how something looks physically	Photograph
To track a trend over time	Line Graph
To show how parts relate to the whole	Pie Chart
To show representative structural details	Diagram / Line Drawing
To present organized numerical data	Table
To contrast discrete categories or values	Bar Graph / Pictograph

4. Designing Graphics

To maximize readability, graphics should remain **neat, simple, integrated with the text, and enhanced with color.**

Integrating Graphics into Text

1. **Placement:** Position small graphics immediately following their first text reference on the same page. Place large graphics at the top of the next page.
2. **Appendices:** For long reports, place extensive or highly complex data sets in an Appendix at the end.
3. **Citations:** If using a graphic from an external source, attribute it directly below the caption (e.g., *Source: NASA, 2024*).

Effective Color Usage

Color captures attention before text. Use color deliberately to:

- **Indicate Organization:** Color-code section headings or category labels consistently.
- **Emphasize Points:** Apply accent colors to call attention to critical values or safety warnings.
- **Support Meaning:** Align colors with standard associations (e.g., Red = Hazard/Stop, Green = Safe/Go).

Guidelines for Color Usage:

- **Limit Palette:** Avoid using more than 3 distinct colors per page/graphic.
- **Maintain Consistency:** Use identical colors for identical elements across the entire document.
- **Cultural Sensitivity:** Be aware of cultural variations (e.g., red symbolizes danger in Western contexts, good fortune in East Asia, and mourning in South Africa).
- **High Contrast:** Avoid low-contrast pairings like orange text on red or purple text on blue.

5. Constructing Graphics (With Examples)

1. Constructing Tables

- **Informal Table:** A light, embedded list without heavy borders or explicit row/column headers.
 - **Example (Informal Table):**

Over the next two months, Theresa lost a total of 4.2 pounds. For every pound of fat she lost, she gained approximately $\frac{3}{4}$ pound of muscle.

Fat lost	14.0 lb
Muscle gained	9.8 lb
Total pounds lost	4.2 lb

- **Formal Table:** A fully structured grid with explicit headers, borders, units, and categorized rows.
 - **Example (Formal Table):**

Table 1 shows the recommended heart rates by age during exercise. The athlete's training rate is for only the most fit athletes. The average training rate is recommended for a healthy person beginning a fitness program.

Table 1. Recommended Heart Rates During Aerobic Exercise

TRAINING RATES ^a			
Age	Maximum Heart Rate	Athlete, 85% ^b	Average, 80%
20	200	170	160
22	198	168	158
24	196	167	157
26	194	165	155
28	192	163	154

^aBased on average heart rates of 72 beats per minute for males and 80 beats per minute for females

^bPercentages represent percents of maximum heart rates in Column 2

Source: Alan Grayson and Suzanne Brazinski, *Exercise and You*, Clearview, ND: Mountain Press, 1994, 72.

Figure 6.6 Model of Formal Table and Introduction

Formal table is labeled Table

Superscript letters refer to footnotes

Stubs

Vertical rules

Footnotes explain parts of the table

Source provides bibliographic data

- **Verbal Table (Chart):** A table that presents qualitative text rather than numerical data.
 - **Example (Verbal Table):**

The following chart shows that some diseases have possible causes in poor eating habits.

DISEASE	DIET
Heart disease, stroke	High in saturated fat
High blood pressure	High in salt
Cancer	Low in fiber, fruits, and vegetables
Diabetes	High in sugar, low in fiber

Source: Raul Amaral, *Nutrition*, New York: Medical Press, 1992, 12.

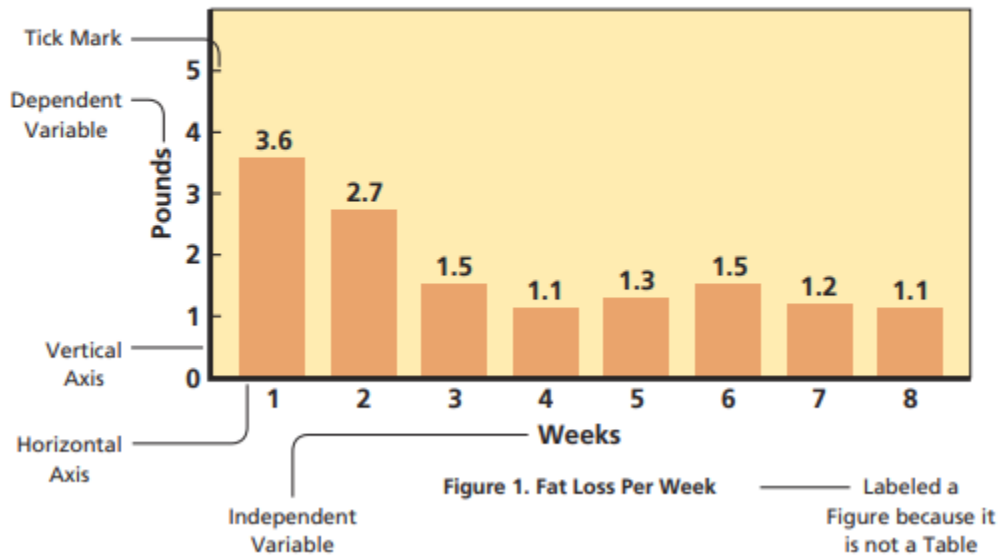
Figure 6.7 Model of a Verbal Table with Introduction

2. Constructing Bar Graphs

Bar graphs compare discrete numerical categories using rectangular bars along horizontal X and vertical Y axes.

- **Single Bar Graph:**

Figure 1 shows the progression of fat loss per week for eight weeks. Notice that the greatest amount of fat loss occurred during weeks 1 (3.6 pounds lost) and 2 (2.7 pounds lost). Weeks 3 (1.5 pounds lost) and 4 (1.1 pounds lost) show the least amount of fat loss.



- **Multiple Bar Graph:** Compares multiple data series side-by-side across categories.

Figure 2 compares the amount of fat lost to the number of pounds gained. Notice that the amount of muscle gained is small compared to the amount of fat lost during the first weeks. However, as the fat loss stabilized during weeks 7 and 8, the amount of muscle gain is slightly higher. Muscle is denser than fat. As the body converts more fat to muscle, the net effect is to gain weight while still losing fat.

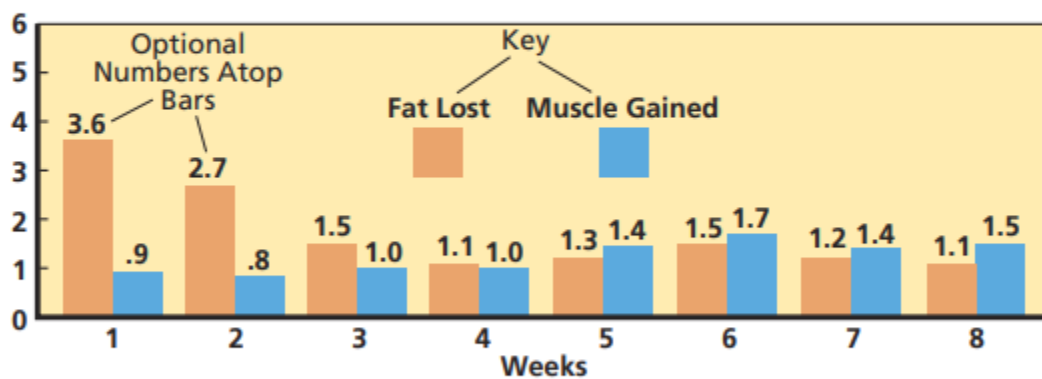


Figure 6.9 Model of a Double Bar Graph with Introduction

3. Constructing Line Graphs

Line graphs connect discrete data points to illustrate trends over a continuous variable (such as time).

- **Single Line Graph Example:**

Figure 3 shows how the fat loss peaked in the earlier weeks, dropped remarkably during the middle weeks, and plateaued during the last four weeks.

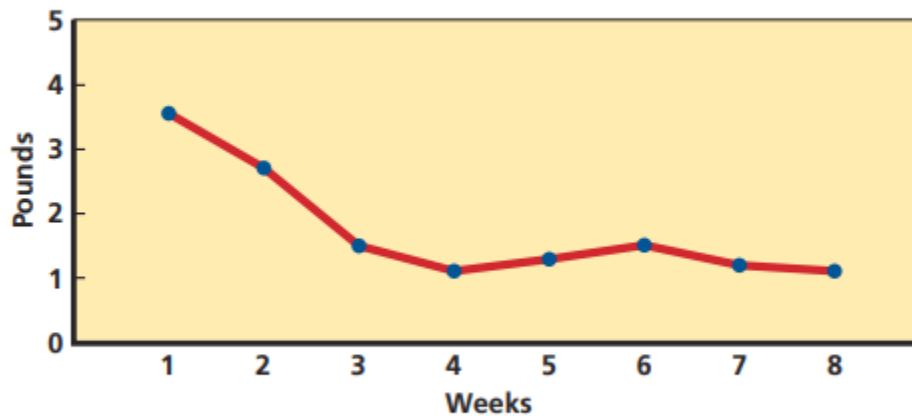


Figure 3. Fat Loss (8 weeks)

Figure 6.10 Model of Line Graph with Introduction

- **Multiple Line Graph Example:**

Figure 4 illustrates that the relationship between fat loss and muscle gain is more evenly matched after the first weeks of the physical fitness program. During the first two weeks, the amount of muscle gain is minimal and fat loss is at its maximum. As the fat loss plateaus, the muscle gain stabilizes, surpassing fat loss by a few ounces.

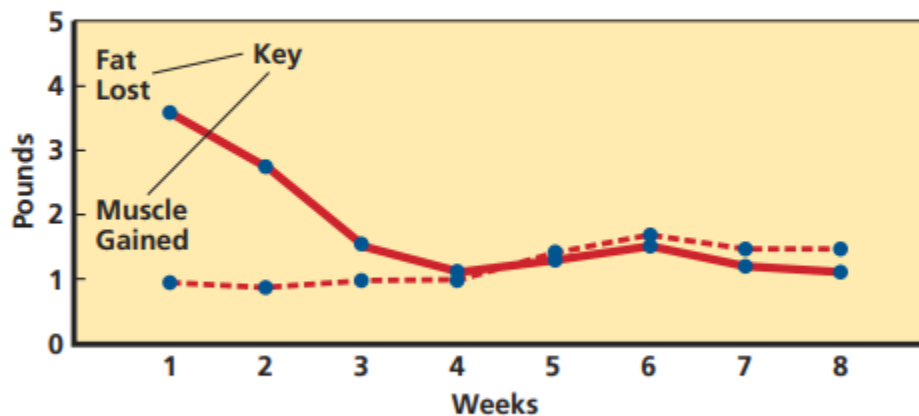


Figure 4. Fat Loss (8 weeks)

Figure 6.11 Model of Double Line Graph with Introduction

4. Constructing Pictographs

Pictographs use simple visual icons rather than solid bars to represent quantities.

Figure 5 shows the average number of servings of fruits and vegetables that the employees of Grow Organic Consortium ate for a month. The teamwork and friendly competition motivated them to meet the goal of eight servings during most weeks.

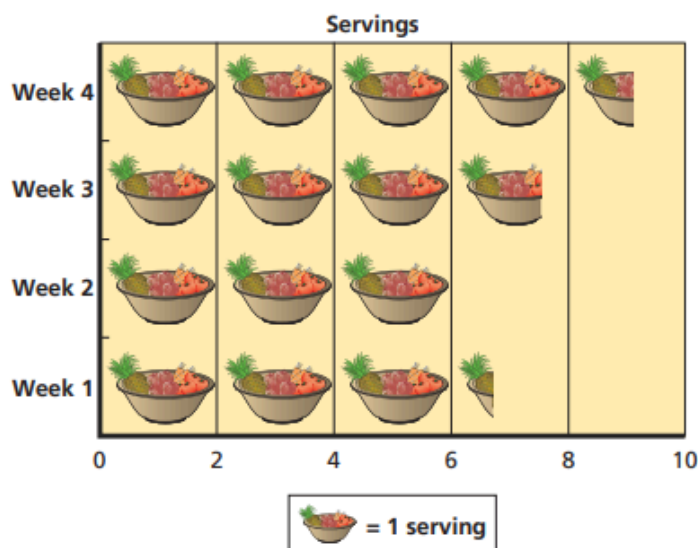


Figure 5. Average Number of Servings Consumed in One Month

Figure 6.12 Average Consumption of Fruits and Vegetables for Four Weeks at Grow Organic Consortium—Model of Pictograph with Introduction

5. Constructing Pie Graphs

Pie graphs show proportional relationships (percentages of a 100% whole). Limit pie charts to 7 or fewer segments.

- **Standard Pie Graph Example:**

Figure 6 shows the amount of protein, carbohydrates, and fat a person on a fitness plan needs in one day. Surprisingly, the human body needs more carbohydrates (65%) than protein and much less fat than previously thought.

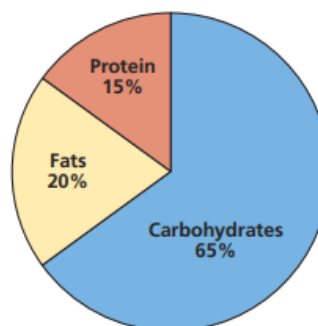


Figure 6. Daily Recommendations of Protein, Carbohydrates, and Fat

Figure 6.13 Model of Pie Graph with Introduction

- **Exploding Pie Graph Example:**

Figure 7 shows the percentages of carbohydrates from different sources consumed in one week by Samir, a teen at risk for type 2 diabetes. Half the carbohydrates consumed come from unhealthy simple sugars. Note that more than 1/5 of his weekly intake comes from soft drinks alone.

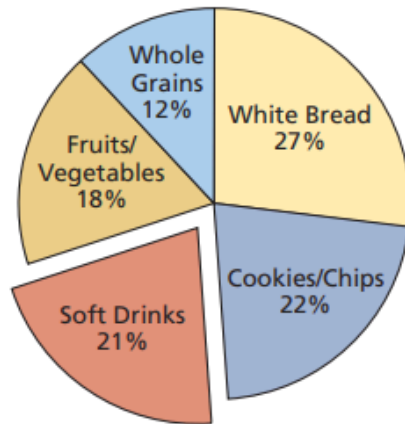


Figure 7. Types of Carbohydrates Consumed

Figure 6.14 Model of Exploding Pie Graph with Introduction

6. Constructing Charts and Diagrams

- **Flowchart:** Illustrates step-by-step technical or operational workflows.

Figure 8 shows what happens when sugars and starches are digested to glucose. The glucose that is not used by the brain or muscles is converted to fat.

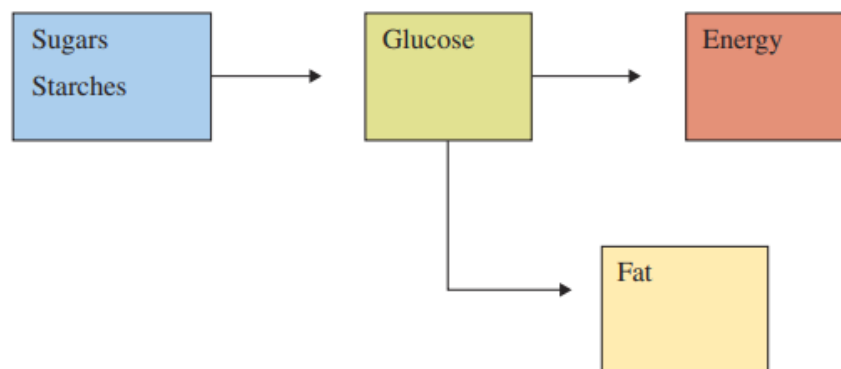


Figure 8. Result When Sugars and Starches Are Digested

Figure 6.15 Model of Flowchart with Introduction

- **Decision Flowchart:** Incorporates diamond decision symbols (◊) representing conditional choices (e.g., Yes / No paths).

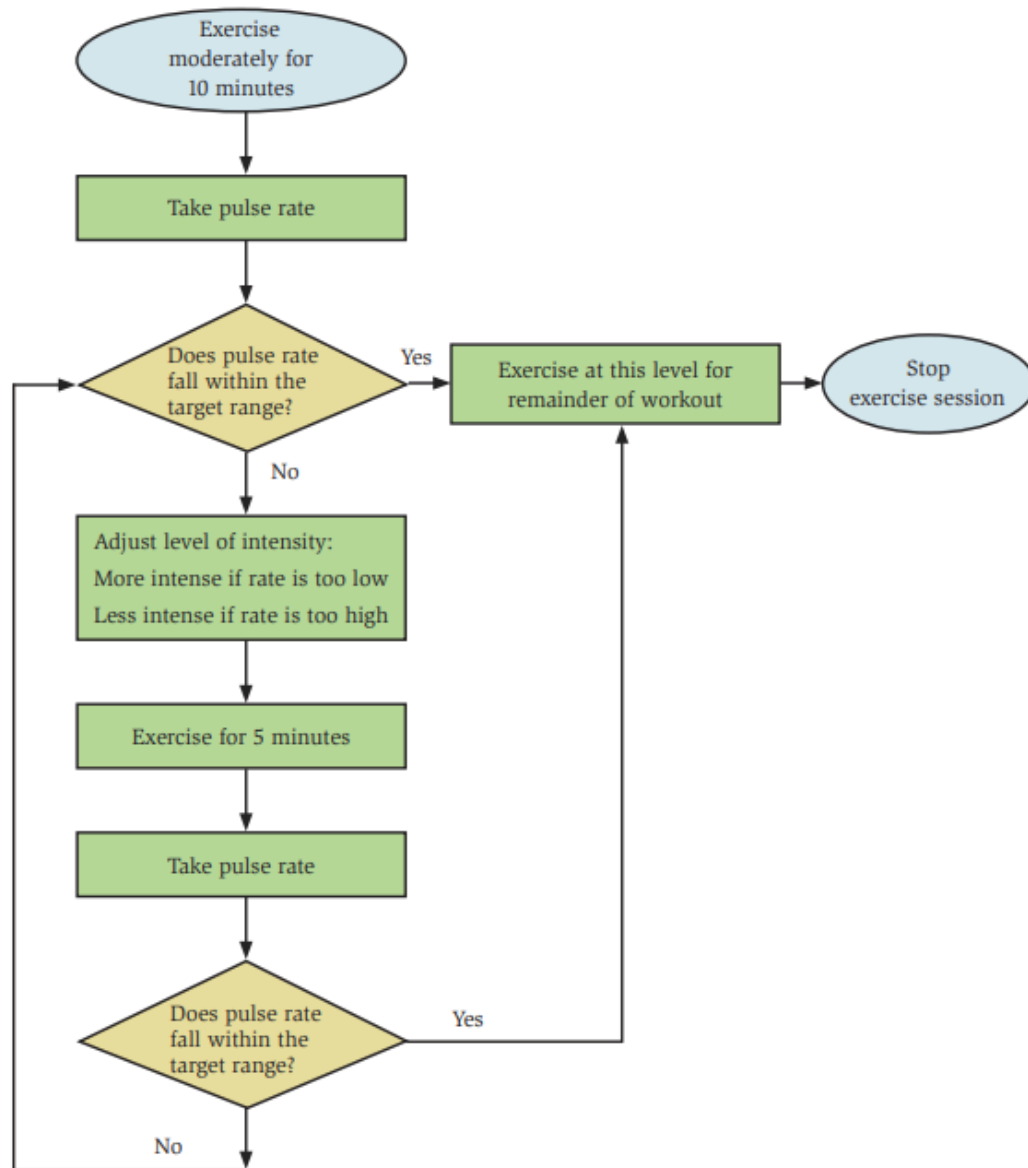


Figure 9. Process for Adjusting Your Training Rate

Figure 6.16 Model of Decision Flowchart with Introduction

- **Organizational Chart:** Visualizes administrative or structural hierarchies.

The following chart shows the organization of the school's Wellness Center.

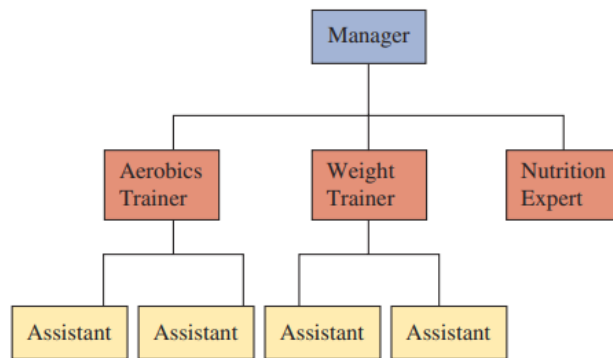


Figure 6.17 Model of Organizational Chart with Introduction

- **Gantt Chart:** A bar-chart schedule mapping project tasks against time durations.

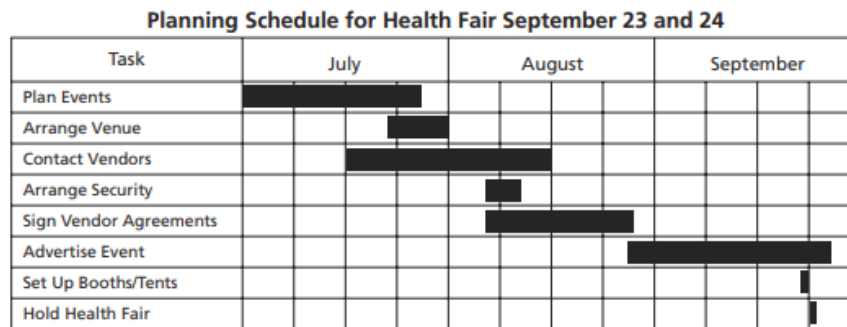


Figure 6.18 Health Fair Planning Schedule—Model of Gantt Chart

- **Diagram (Line Drawing with Callouts):** Exploded or detailed technical schematic featuring labeled pointer lines (callouts).

Figure 10 shows how the blood cells clump together abnormally after a dinner high in triglycerides (fat). Notice that when the triglycerides create sludging, blood flow to the capillaries is impeded.

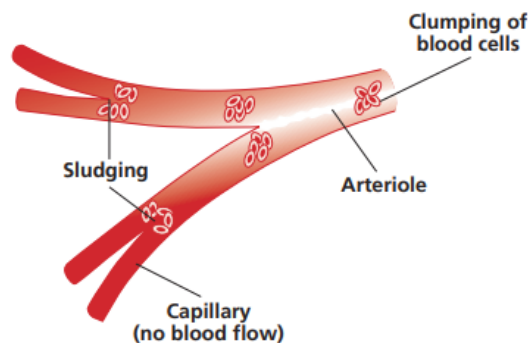


Figure 10. Effect of High Triglycerides on Blood Cells

7. Constructing Icons and Photographs

- **Icon:** A universal visual symbol representing an idea without needing extensive text captions.



- **Photograph:** A camera-captured graphic used to document real-world physical appearance.

Some workers at Sampsun Marine Industries, shown in Figure 6.2, get together every day for a walk through the park.



Figure 6.20 Photograph of Employee Walk with Introduction

UNIT 6: WRITING FOR THE WEB

1. Introduction

Web is the short form of **World Wide Web (WWW)**, also called a webpage. A website is a location of a company or an individual on the internet.

Articles on web pages should be shorter than those in print. Web pages should contain useful information and should be catchy. Too many words, punctuation, and complete sentences should be avoided to increase readability.

2. Getting Started

The word **web** means World Wide Web. It is a collection of online sources.

The **internet** is a global network. It is the infrastructure on which the World Wide Web, emails, and messages travel.

The internet can be compared to a **railway track**, while the web is like a **train running on the track**.

3. Reading Web Pages

Users read online materials differently from printed texts. Books are generally read in a linear way, from one page to another.

Web readers usually **scan information and look for keywords**. They can follow links and jump from one page to another according to their interests. Therefore, readers control the flow of information, and no two readers may read a website in exactly the same way.

Online readers want **speed and convenience**. They do not want to wait for a long time for a page to open. They also do not want to scroll unnecessarily up, down, or sideways to find information.

Therefore, while writing a web page, the writer should consider the way people read web pages.

4. Planning Web Pages

While writing text for the web, consider two main questions:

a) What is your purpose?

The purpose should be made clear on the homepage. A slogan can be placed at the top of the page to show what the website is about.

The purpose of writing a web page may be:

- To inform
- To persuade
- To entertain
- To offer a service
- To solicit opinions
- To define an image
- To create a community

b) Who are your audience?

Online readers come from different backgrounds and different parts of the world. Anyone anywhere in the world can read information written on a web page.

Before preparing a web page, analyze the audience by asking:

- Who is your audience?
- What information do they need?
- What information do they want?
- What will they do with the information?
- Where do they live?
- How old are they?
- What is their income?
- Do they have the latest technology?
- Do they have high-speed internet?

5. Organizing Web Pages

Notes or index cards can be used to list everything that needs to be shown on a website. One item can be written on one card or note. Notes can be arranged with topics and subtopics.

Information on a website can be organized by:

- Category
- Task
- Product
- Date or time
- Department

A.Website Structure

After preparing an outline, decide how to structure the website.

- **Linear structure:** The website moves forward from one page to another in a sequence.
- **Hierarchical structure:** Information is organized vertically from the homepage to other pages, similar to an organization chart.

B.Hyperlinks

A **hyperlink or link** is a word, phrase, or graphic used to connect pages. Links allow viewers to move easily from one page to another. Links may be different in color, underlined, or graphical.

a) External Links:

External links provide more information from another source. Readers should be informed when they are leaving the website. Dead links should not be used because they do not work and can frustrate readers.

b)Internal Links:

Internal links connect pages within the same website. Navigation should be provided so readers can move to other pages and return to the homepage. Without proper navigation, readers may get lost.

6. Designing Web Pages

A web page should be **easy to access, attractive, uncluttered, and symmetrical**.

a. Header

A header, also called a banner, is placed at the top of a web page. Appropriate color and tone should be used in the header.

b. Page Layout

Information should be organized under relevant headings. Headings help readers scan and find relevant information.

Long pages can be divided into shorter pages, and links can be provided to these pages. Pages should not require horizontal scrolling.

c.Line Length

Text lines should not be too long. About **50–70 characters, or 10–12 words per line**, is recommended.

Short lines require less eye movement when scanning information.

d. Graphics

Graphics provide visual relief, support the content, and make the website attractive.

Too many graphics should not be used, as graphics that take too long to load can discourage readers.

Common formats are:

- **JPEG** – Joint Photographic Experts Group
- **GIF** – Graphics Interchange Format
- **PNG** – Portable Network Graphics

e. Multimedia

Animation, audio, and video can make a web page more interesting. Too much movement of graphics or text may annoy readers.

f. Tables

Tables are used to organize text and graphics. They make the page clean and uniform. One table can be nested inside another table.

g. Borders

Borders can be used to draw boundaries between sections. Borders may also be omitted to give a smoother look.

h. Fonts

Sans serif fonts are suitable for online text because they can be easily seen on a screen.

Boldface and italics can be used to focus on important words or phrases. Underlining should generally be avoided because users may think the underlined text is a link.

i. Colors

Colors can make a website attractive, though colors may have different meanings in different cultures.

Contrasting colors should be used for text and background so that text is easy to read

j. Consistency

All pages should have a similar appearance. The same design features should be used in the same place on every page.

Logo, colors, and font sizes should be used consistently.

k. Accessibility

Information on a web page should be available to people with disabilities. **WCAG (Web Content Accessibility Guidelines)** can be followed for web accessibility.

Disabilities may include:

- Visual
- Hearing
- Cognitive
- Movement
- Speech

7. Writing Text for the Web

Strategies to be Considered

a. Page Title:

Write a short and descriptive title for each page. The title should tell visitors what is on the page. The logo should appear in the upper-left corner of each page.

b. Audience:

Analyze the audience to meet their needs. Avoid jargon unless the audience understands it.

c. Inverted Pyramid:

Write the most important points first. Give supporting information after the important information.

d. Facts, Not Hype:

Make the web page informative. Give facts that readers can use. Avoid exaggerated expressions and unnecessary sales appeal.

e. Original Phrases:

Avoid clichés such as “click here” or “check out this site”. Give the link naturally as a part of the sentence.

f. Standard English:

Use standard English and follow correct rules of pronunciation and usage. Errors can reduce the credibility of a web page.

8. Writing Scannable Text

Words should be reduced so that the text is easy to scan. Readers should be able to locate important words and phrases quickly. Information should be given using fewer words wherever possible.

a.Short Paragraphs

Paragraphs should be short. A paragraph should contain about **6–8 lines**.

b.Short Sentences

Sentences should be short, clear, and easy to read. A sentence should contain about **20–25 words**.

c.Headings

Use short and informative headings. Headings help readers decide quickly what they want to read and indicate a shift from one idea to another.

d.Paragraphs to Lists

Break long paragraphs into bulleted lists. Lists reduce the amount of text and focus on important content.

3.Keywords

Use keywords that help readers find useful information. Readers can scan text with the help of keywords, and keywords also help readers find the website.

9. Special Web Pages

Special web pages include:

- Home Page
- Blogs
- FAQ
- Wikis
- Discussion Forums

A.Home Page

The home page is like a **gate to a park**. It should be attractive, reflect the theme of the website, and provide basic information about the website.

Factors to Consider

- **Write the purpose:** Use a catchy phrase or meaningful slogan to draw attention.
- **Short introduction and conclusion:** The introduction explains the purpose, and the conclusion brings the page to a close.
- **Links to short online articles:** Short articles can be provided with links.

A homepage should include essential information:

- Email address and phone number
- Logo
- About section
- Navigation system
- Date when the website was last updated
- Disclaimer or privacy statement

B.Blog

A **blog (weblog)** is similar to a journal. It contains commentary or news that comes periodically.

A blogger is a person who has knowledge and passion about a topic. A blog is a source of information where viewers can also respond. It helps create an online community and is interactive.

Blogs may contain links and graphics, and their writing style is generally informal. Its main function is to provide a regularly updated and chronological diary of an individual on a topic where readers can give comments.

Factors to Consider When Posting a Blog

- Write about topics that you know.
- Post regularly, but do not post too many.
- Create a short and easy-to-remember name.
- Communicate with people on other blogs.
- Post meaningful and accurate information.
- Make the blog interesting and attractive.

C.FAQ

FAQ stands for **Frequently Asked Questions**. It is a web page where commonly asked questions are answered to provide useful information to readers.

While Preparing an FAQ

- Know the commonly asked questions and find out what readers want to know.
- Keep answers short.

- Use a consistent format for questions and answers.
- Update the FAQ from time to time.
- Organize questions according to their importance.
- Proofread the FAQ.
- Place the FAQ where readers can find it easily.

D.Wikis

A **wiki** is a web page that uses special software where many users can write and edit web pages collaboratively.

Types of Wikis

- **Open Wiki:** Anyone can contribute by writing and editing.
- **Closed Wiki:** Only selected people are allowed to write and edit.

While Using a Wiki

- Read several articles before writing or editing.
- Be polite even when disagreeing.
- Include factual information.
- Write references when materials are taken from other sources.

Discussion Forums

A **discussion forum** is a place where many people discuss topics and get answers to their questions. Answers to many different questions can be found in discussion forums.

Factors to Remember

- Read other posts to understand how people respond.
- Provide as much information as possible.
- Give accurate information when responding.
- Think critically about other people's responses, as every response may not be believable.

UNIT 7: INFORMATIVE REPORTS

1. Introduction

Reports are a form of **technical writing**. Professional people write reports to convey information about their work.

The most frequently used informative reports are:

1. Summary and Abstract
2. Mechanism Description
3. Progress Report
4. Periodic Report
5. News Release

2. Summary and Abstract

A **summary** is a shorter version of a document. It contains all the important points of the original document.

Usually, the length of a summary is about **33% of the original document**, that is, about one-third of the original.

An **abstract** is even shorter than a summary. It gives the **essence of the subject matter** of the text.

Summaries and abstracts are written because people may not have enough time to read long reports. They depend on summaries and abstracts to find the most important information they need.

Features of a Summary or Abstract

- Personal comments, interpretations, agreements, or disagreements should **not** be included.
- The language should be **simple and direct**.
- Figurative language, slang, colloquial expressions, and clichés should be avoided.
- Extra details such as examples, detailed descriptions, and lengthy discussions should be avoided.
- The writing should be **clear and coherent**.

- Information should follow smoothly and should read well.
- A summary may have several paragraphs.
- An abstract is usually written in **one paragraph**.
- An abstract is usually written in one page, while a summary may cover several pages depending on the length of the original text.

Factors to Consider When Writing a Summary or Abstract

1. Take notes while listening to an oral presentation.
2. For a written document, read it at least twice, or as many times as required until you understand it fully.
3. When reading for the second time, highlight the **main ideas**.
4. Paraphrase the main ideas and write them in **your own words**.
5. Write the **thesis or main point in the first sentence**.

Example

Original idea:

Regular exercise improves physical health, reduces stress, and helps people maintain a healthy lifestyle.

Summary:

Regular exercise improves physical health, reduces stress, and supports a healthy lifestyle.

Abstract:

Regular exercise provides important physical and mental health benefits.

3. Mechanism Description

A **mechanism description** is also called a **manual** or **instruction manual**. It describes the main parts of a device or machine and explains how it works.

When you buy new equipment such as a **cooker, camera, laptop, or mobile phone**, you get a mechanism description in the form of instructions.

It tells you:

- What the parts are
- How the parts fit together
- How the parts work
- How the device works

A mechanism description explains:

- The purpose of the mechanism or device
- Its design
- Its parts
- What it looks like
- How it works
- How the parts work together

Uses of Mechanism Description

It is used in:

- Catalogs
- Instruction manuals
- Employee training
- Other technical documents

Factors to Keep in Mind When Writing a Mechanism Description

- Take notes.**
 - Describe every part in detail.
 - Describe the function of each part.
- Use **spatial order**:
 - Left to right
 - Right to left
 - Top to bottom
 - Bottom to top
 - Or any other suitable pattern
- Divide the mechanism into parts and discuss each part with a **header**.
- Begin with the overall physical appearance.
- Explain:
 - What the device is designed to do
 - Its parts
 - Size
 - Color
 - Location of parts
 - Material it is made of
- Give a **graphic/diagram** of the mechanism.
- Give enlarged or **exploded views** of parts that are too small to be seen easily.
- Use **active voice** wherever possible.

Mechanism Description — Laptop

A **laptop** is a portable electronic device used for performing tasks such as writing documents, browsing the internet, programming, and playing multimedia.

Main Parts

1. Display/Screen

The screen displays text, images, videos, and other information. It is attached to the upper part of the laptop.

2. Keyboard

The keyboard is located below the screen. It is used to enter letters, numbers, and commands.

3. Touchpad

The touchpad is located below the keyboard. It is used to control the pointer and perform actions without using a separate mouse.

4. Processor

The processor performs calculations and processes instructions given by software.

5. Memory (RAM)

RAM temporarily stores data and programs that are currently being used by the computer.

6. Storage

The storage device keeps files, programs, and other data even when the laptop is turned off.

7. Battery

The battery supplies power to the laptop when it is not connected to an external power source.

8. Ports

Ports are provided on the sides of the laptop for connecting devices such as USB devices, displays, and other equipment.

How a Laptop Works

When the laptop is turned on, the battery or external power source provides electrical power. The processor executes instructions, while RAM temporarily stores the data and programs being used. The storage device keeps permanent files and programs. The display shows the output, while the keyboard and touchpad allow the user to provide input.

Mechanism Description — Mobile Phone

A **mobile phone** is a portable electronic device used for communication and for performing various other tasks such as taking photographs, accessing the internet, and using applications.

Main Parts

1. Display/Touchscreen

The touchscreen displays information and allows the user to interact with the phone by touching different areas of the screen.

2. Battery

The battery provides electrical power to the phone.

3. Processor

The processor processes instructions and controls the operations of the phone.

4. Camera

The camera captures photographs and videos.

5. Speaker

The speaker produces sound for calls, music, videos, and notifications.

6. Microphone

The microphone receives the user's voice and other sounds.

7. SIM Card Slot

The SIM card slot holds the SIM card used for connecting the phone to a mobile network.

8. Storage

Storage keeps applications, photographs, videos, documents, and other data.

How a Mobile Phone Works

The battery supplies power to the phone. The processor controls the operations of the device and processes instructions. The touchscreen receives input from the user and the display provides output. The microphone receives sound, while the speaker produces sound. The camera captures photographs and videos, while storage keeps the user's data and applications.

4. Periodic Report

A **periodic report** explains the work accomplished by an organization during a certain period of time.

It explains what is going on and how much work is being completed in an organization or group.

A periodic report may be:

- **Weekly** — every week
- **Monthly** — every month
- **Quarterly** — every three months
- **Semi-annually** — every six months

Organizations use periodic reports to inform **shareholders, clients, and employees** about the organization's achievements.

Factors to Consider When Writing a Periodic Report

1. Consider all activities and achievements of the organization.
2. Meet the needs of the audience.
3. Organize tasks logically so that readers can find information easily.
4. Use a suitable format:
 - For an **internal audience**, it can be written in memo format.
 - For an **external audience**, it can be written in letter/report format.
5. Do not give personal opinions.

Example

A company's **monthly periodic report** may describe:

- Products sold during the month
- Work completed
- New clients
- Major achievements
- Activities completed by different departments

5. Progress Report

A **progress report** describes what has been done during a certain period of time in an organization.

It covers the **achievements and plans for the future**.

It is written to inform others about the progress of an **ongoing project**. It includes what has been completed and what is currently going on in the project.

Factors to Consider When Writing a Progress Report

A progress report should be organized to answer the readers' most important questions.

It should:

- Name the project.
- Indicate the time period.
- State the purpose of the work.
- Explain what has been completed.
- Explain what is currently being done.
- Explain what needs to be done in the future.
- Mention any problems affecting completion of the work.

Use of Tense

Past tense should be used for work that has already been completed.

Example: *We completed the database design.*

Future tense should be used for work that will be completed in the future.

Example: *We will begin testing the system next week.*

Use of First-Person Pronouns

Use **I** or **We**. This shows responsibility for actions and opinions.

Example: *We completed the first phase of the project.*

Example

Project: Student Attendance Management System

Time Period: August–September

Purpose: To develop an online system for managing student attendance.

Completed Work:

The database and login system have been completed.

Current Work:

We are developing the teacher attendance interface.

Future Work:

We will develop the student attendance-viewing system.

Problems:

Some problems were encountered while connecting the application to the database.

Difference Between Periodic Report and Progress Report

Periodic Report	Progress Report
Reports work accomplished during a specific period.	Reports the progress of an ongoing project or work.
May be weekly, monthly, quarterly, or semi-annually.	Focuses on the current stage of an ongoing project.
Mainly informs shareholders, clients, or employees about organizational activities and achievements.	Informs people about what has been completed, what is going on, and what remains to be done.
Covers activities and achievements of an organization during a period.	Covers achievements, current work, future plans, and problems related to a project.
Personal opinions should not be given.	First-person pronouns such as I and We can be used.
Mainly focuses on activities completed during a period.	Discusses past, present, and future work.

6. News Release

A **news release**, also called a **press release**, is a kind of news article released by a company.

Its purpose is to pass information to the public through mass media such as:

- Newspapers
- Radio
- Television

The company itself writes information about its:

- Product
- Service
- Event
- New development

Therefore, the information is supposed to be **accurate**.

A news release is used to report **events or facts**. Its goal is to inform people about the activities of a company.

It also helps the company maintain a **positive image**.

Example

A company launching a new mobile phone may issue a news release explaining:

- The name of the new phone
- Its main features
- The launch date
- Where it will be available
- Other important information about the product

ABC Technologies Launches New Student Laptop

FOR IMMEDIATE RELEASE

Kathmandu, September 5, 2026 — ABC Technologies has announced the launch of its new student laptop, designed to provide students with a reliable and affordable device for their academic work.

The new laptop includes a high-resolution display, a fast processor, sufficient storage, and a long-lasting battery. It is designed for activities such as attending online classes, preparing assignments, browsing the internet, and using educational software.

The laptop will be available from September 15, 2026, through ABC Technologies' authorized stores and online platform.

About ABC Technologies

ABC Technologies is a technology company that provides computers, mobile devices, and other electronic products to students and general consumers.

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Unit 8: Employment Communication

1. Introduction

Employment communication refers to the written communication used when applying for, getting, or leaving a job.

It includes:

- **Resume (CV or Bio-data)**
- **Cover letter (Job application letter)**
- **Follow-up letter** to thank the employer after an interview
- **Resignation letter** when leaving a job

2. Factors to Consider When Writing Employment Communication

A. Highlight Your Strengths

Focus on your:

- Education
- Skills
- Job experience
- Aptitudes
- Accomplishments

Example:

If you are applying for a software developer position, highlight programming skills, software projects, relevant education, and previous development experience.

B. Research Your Prospective Employer

Gather information about the company and the job before applying.

You should know:

- When the company was established
- Its mission
- Its past record

- Details about the position
- What you are expected to do
- Who you will work with
- What skills the company is looking for

This helps you write according to the requirements of the employer.

C. Choose Your References

A **reference** is a person who knows you well and can provide information about you to a company that is seeking employees.

Usually, you can choose **three to five people** as references. You should ask their permission before using their names as references.

Example:

A teacher, university professor, or previous employer who knows your work can be used as a reference.

3. Who Reads Employment Communication?

Employers read employment communication because they are looking for someone who can fulfill the needs of their company.

Therefore, a resume and cover letter should be written from the **employer's perspective**, according to the expectations of the employer.

Employment communication should:

- Have no errors.
- Be neat.
- Look professional.
- Clearly show your relevant qualifications and skills.

4. Formatting and Organizing Resumes

Formatting Resumes

A **resume**, also called a **CV (Curriculum Vitae)** or **bio-data**, gives information about your education, skills, experience, and qualifications.

Employers do not usually have enough time to read resumes thoroughly. They may spend only **15 to 45 seconds** looking at a resume for the first time.

Therefore, a resume should stand out and clearly show your important information.

A resume is like an **advertisement for your skills**.

Usually, a resume should be **one or two pages long**. Electronic resumes can be longer.

Formatting Guidelines

You can use:

- **Boldface**
- *Italics*
- Underlining
- CAPITALS
- Bullets

These should be used carefully so that the resume does not become difficult to read.

Leave enough **white space** around the margins.

Use an easy-to-read font such as **Times New Roman, Calibri, or Arial**, usually in **10–12 point** size.

Basic Information in a Resume

A resume generally contains:

Identification

- Name
- Address
- Mobile number
- Email address

Education

- School or university
- Dates of graduation
- Division, percentage, or GPA
- Major courses

Job Experience

- Company name and address

- Position
- Duties and responsibilities

Other possible headings include:

- Job objective
- Computer skills
- Technical skills
- Leadership skills
- Related experience
- Honors and awards

5. Organizing Resumes

There are two main organizational strategies.

a. Reverse Chronological Order

Past jobs, schools, and universities are listed beginning with the **most recent** and moving toward the oldest.

Example:

Education:

1. Bachelor's Degree — 2025
2. +2 — 2022
3. SEE — 2020

This makes recent education and experience easy to find.

b. Priority Order

Information is arranged according to what is **most impressive or important** for the particular job.

For example, if your work experience is stronger, you can put **work experience before education**.

If your skills are more important, you can put **skills before work experience and education**.

6. Types of Resumes

A. Chronological Resume

In a **chronological resume**, education and job experience are presented in **reverse chronological order**, beginning with the most recent information.

It usually presents education and work experience before other information.

Advantages

- Easy to read quickly
- Familiar to employers
- Acceptable to most employers

Disadvantages

- Can become too long if a person has many work experiences
- Not very suitable for people who have little or no work experience

Example:

Work Experience

- Software Developer — ABC Software, 2025–Present
- Junior Developer — XYZ Technologies, 2023–2025
- Intern — Tech Solutions, 2022–2023

B. Functional Resume

A **functional resume** focuses mainly on a person's **skills and qualifications** rather than the dates of employment.

It is more flexible and emphasizes the most important skills.

Dates are less important in this type of resume.

Example

Career Objective:

To obtain a software developer position with a software company.

Summary of Qualifications:

- Competent in C, C++, Java, PHP, and MySQL
- Competent system analyzer
- Website design experience

Education:

- Bachelor in Computer Science
- +2 in Computer Science

Skills:

- Programming
- Website design
- Graphic design
- Writing and editing

3. Electronic Resume

An **electronic resume** can be either chronological or functional and is sent electronically.

There are different forms of electronic resumes:

a. Email Resume

A resume sent as part of an email, usually as an attachment.

Example:

You send an email to a company and attach your resume as a PDF file.

b. ASCII Text Resume

ASCII stands for **American Standard Code for Information Interchange**.

It uses special text formatting and can be attached to an email.

c. Scannable Resume

A scannable resume is designed to be scanned electronically for **keywords**.

An employer can search the resume using keywords related to the job.

Example:

For a programming job, keywords may include:

- C++
- Java
- Database
- Web Development
- SQL

d. Online Resume

An online resume is posted on a company's website or on your own website.

7. Composing Resumes

Factors to Consider When Writing Resumes**a. Word Choice**

A resume should provide information using a few **words**.

Normally, sentences and paragraphs are not used. Instead, resumes use:

- Phrases
- Lists
- Verbs
- Nouns
- Descriptive phrases

Example:

- Member, Lions Club
- Key Club Treasurer
- Girl Scout Leader

Use **present tense** for a job you currently hold.

Use **past tense** for jobs you held in the past.

Example:

- Present job: *Develop software applications.*
- Previous job: *Developed software applications.*

b. Specific Language

Use clear and specific language when describing your:

- Objective
- Skills
- Work experience
- Responsibilities

Specific:

Objective: To work as a loan officer in a local bank branch.

This clearly identifies the position.

Vague:

Objective: To work as a professional in a modern banking environment.

The second example does not clearly identify the type of job or workplace.

c. Parallel Structure

Use the same structure consistently for similar information in a resume.

For example, if you write the name of one school in a particular format, use the same format for the other schools and universities.

Example:

- Tribhuvan University — Bachelor in Computer Science
- ABC College — +2 in Science
- XYZ School — SEE

The information follows a consistent structure.

d. Keywords for Scannable Resumes

For a scannable resume, use **nouns instead of verbs** when listing skills and qualifications.

Examples:

Skills:

- C++ Programming
- Graphic Design
- Database Management

Job Titles:

- Manager
- Supervisor
- Administrative Assistant

These words can be used as keywords when an employer searches the resume.

e. Punctuation

- Use **colons (:)** to introduce lists.
- Use **commas (,)** to separate simple lists of three or more items.
- Use **periods (.)** to break up large amounts of text or indicate a change in information.

8. Composing Employment Letters

Employment letters are written using **paragraphs and complete sentences**.

They provide an opportunity to:

- Show how well you write
- Present your skills
- Present your abilities

There are three main types of employment letters:

- **Cover letter** — accompanies the resume
- **Follow-up letter** — thanks the employer after an interview
- **Resignation letter** — informs the employer that you are leaving the company

9. Cover Letter

A **cover letter** is a type of sales letter in which you try to sell your services to the employer.

Its purpose is to **persuade the employer to select you for the job**.

A cover letter has three main parts:

A. Opening

The opening is the first paragraph and is used to **get the employer's attention**.

You can:

- Show your interest in the job
- Explain how you found the job advertisement

Most cover letters are **solicited**, meaning that the job has been advertised or requested.

In this case, mention the **date and source of the advertisement**.

Sometimes a person may send an **unsolicited letter**, even when no job has been advertised.

In this situation, you can attract the employer's attention by mentioning your skills and qualifications.

You can also use **name dropping**, where you mention that someone suggested you contact the employer.

B. Summary of Qualifications

The second and third paragraphs describe:

- Education
- Qualifications
- Work experience
- Related job skills

The purpose is to convince the employer that you are an appropriate candidate.

If you have little work experience, write about your **education first**.

If you have considerable work experience, you can write about **work experience before education**.

C. Request for Interview

The final paragraph should request an **interview**.

Mention that your resume is attached for detailed consideration.

Also provide your:

- Phone number
- Email address
- Preferred way of contacting you

Simple Example of a Cover Letter

Dear Sir/Madam,

I am writing in response to your advertisement for the position of Junior Software Developer. I am interested in this position and believe that my education and programming skills make me a suitable candidate.

I have completed my Bachelor's degree in Computer Science and have experience working with Java, C++, and database systems. I have also worked on several academic software projects that helped me develop my programming and problem-solving skills.

I would appreciate the opportunity to discuss my qualifications in an interview. My resume is enclosed for your consideration. I can be contacted by phone or email at your convenience.

Yours sincerely,

Your Name

10. Follow-up Letter

A **follow-up letter**, also called a **thank-you letter**, is written immediately after a job interview.

Its purpose is to:

- Thank the employer for the interview
- Express interest in the job
- Explain why you are a suitable candidate
- Remind the employer of your qualifications

Example

Dear Ms. Sharma,

Thank you for giving me the opportunity to attend the interview for the Software Developer position. It was a pleasure to meet you and learn more about your organization.

After the interview, I am even more interested in joining your company. I believe that my programming skills, education, and ability to work with a team would allow me to contribute effectively to the organization.

Please contact me if you need any additional information. I look forward to hearing from you.

Regards,
YourName

11. Resignation Letter

A **resignation letter** is written when you decide to leave your job.

It should use **polite language** because maintaining goodwill with the employer is important. A positive relationship can also help when you need the employer as a reference in the future.

A resignation letter should include:

- Your intention to leave the company
- Your last working date
- A thank-you to the employer
- Reason for leaving
- A positive closing

Example

Dear Ms. Sharma,

I would like to inform you that I am resigning from my position as an Account Executive at ABC Company, effective October 1, 2026.

I am grateful for the opportunities for professional and personal development that I have received during my time with the company. I have enjoyed working with the organization and appreciate the support provided by my colleagues and management.

I will do my best to complete my responsibilities and assist with the transition before my last working day.

Thank you for the opportunities and experience I have gained during my employment.

Sincerely,

Your Name

Chapter 9: Presentations

1. Introduction

A **presentation** is the process of sharing information with a large audience by a speaker. It is a kind of **technical talk or speech** delivered to an audience.

There are several situations where presentations are given, such as:

- Giving training
- Sharing a report
- Selling goods or services
- Motivating someone to do something

Example:

A software company employee may give a presentation to explain a new software product to customers.

2. Types of Presentation

There are two main types of presentations:

1. Internal Presentation

An **internal presentation** is made within an organization. The audience belongs to the same organization as the speaker.

The audience may include:

- Co-workers
- Managers
- Supervisors
- Other employees

It is usually **informal**.

Example:

An employee presenting a new project idea to their manager and co-workers.

2. External Presentation

An **external presentation** is made outside the organization.

The audience may include:

- Suppliers
- Customers
- Vendors
- Other people outside the organization

It is usually **formal**.

Example:

A company presenting a new product to its customers.

3. Formal and Informal Presentations

Some presentations are **formal**, while others are **informal**.

Formal Presentation

People working in areas such as **sales and marketing** often give formal presentations.

A formal presentation is:

- Elaborately prepared
- Carefully planned in advance
- Rehearsed before delivery

It may be held in:

- Conference rooms
- Auditoriums
- Large halls

It may use tools such as:

- Podium
- Microphone
- Whiteboard
- Smart board
- Projector
- Posters
- Product samples

Example:

A sales team presenting a company's new mobile phone to potential customers using slides, product samples, and a projector.

External presentations are generally formal.

Informal Presentation

An **informal presentation** is usually made without extensive preparation and rehearsal. It may happen spontaneously when someone needs to explain an idea or answer questions.

Examples:

- Presenting an idea to your manager
- Discussing a topic during a meeting
- Answering questions about a project

Internal presentations are generally informal.

4. Planning Presentations

When planning a presentation, the important factors to consider are:

Audience, topic, location, time, stage fright, and graphic aids.

1. Audience

Knowing your audience is very important because your speaking style should change according to the people you are speaking to.

For example, managers, co-workers, customers, technical experts, and the general public have different needs and different levels of understanding.

You should use language that your audience can understand.

Before making the presentation, consider:

- Who are the audience?
- Are they customers, technical experts, managers, sales staff, or the general public?
- What do they already know?
- How much do they know?
- What do they want to know?
- What do they need to know?
- Is the audience a single person or a group?

- Is the group small or large?
- How will they use the information?
- Do they understand technical jargon?
- Do you need to explain the jargon?
- Why are you making the presentation?
- What do you want to achieve?

The better you know your audience, the better you can meet their needs and achieve the purpose of your presentation.

Example:

When explaining a programming system to software developers, you can use technical terms. When explaining the same system to ordinary customers, you should use simpler language.

2. Topic

Sometimes you are given a topic for a presentation, such as:

- Progress report
- Solution to a problem
- Incident report

Sometimes you can choose the topic yourself.

The topic should be selected according to:

- Audience's needs
- Audience's level of understanding
- Audience's interests
- Purpose of the presentation
- Your own comfort with the topic

The purpose may be to:

- Inform
- Explain
- Describe
- Persuade

You should gather information about the topic by:

- Visiting libraries
- Interviewing experts
- Browsing the internet

Example:

If the purpose is to inform students, a topic such as "**Benefits of Online Learning**" may be suitable.

5. Location

The **location**, or **venue**, is also important when planning a presentation.

You should consider the location from both the **speaker's** and **audience's** perspectives.

Speaker's Considerations

Consider:

- Is there a podium?
- Will you stand directly in front of the audience?
- Will you sit in front of or with the audience?
- Is the stage elevated?
- Are you at the same level as the audience?
- How much space is available for movement?
- How loudly will you need to speak?

Audience's Considerations

Consider:

- Is the location easy to find and reach?
- Is it comfortable and appropriate?
- Is the lighting suitable?
- Is the temperature comfortable?
- Will the audience be seated or standing?
- Are the seats arranged properly?
- Is the location accessible to people with disabilities?
- Can everyone see and hear the speaker?

Example:

For a large presentation, the room should have enough seating, proper lighting, a working microphone, and a projector that everyone can see.

6. Time

You need to know how much time has been given to you for the presentation.

If the host has not specified the time, you should ask.

You should also adjust your speaking speed according to the content.

Speak **slowly when explaining complex ideas** so that the audience can understand them.

Example:

If you have 10 minutes to explain a technical system, organize the content so that the introduction, main explanation, and conclusion fit within those 10 minutes.

7. Stage Fright

Stage fright, also called **stage fear**, is the nervousness a person feels when speaking in front of an audience.

Many people become nervous when they have to speak before a large group.

Some symptoms include:

- Faster heartbeat
- Sweating
- Dry mouth
- Shaking hands or legs
- Knees shaking
- Loss of memory

Guidelines for Reducing Nervousness

1. Research your topic

Collect enough information by using books, the internet, and interviews with experts.

2. Analyze your audience

Understand their level, needs, existing knowledge, and expectations.

3. Outline your message

Arrange your ideas in a logical order.

4. Rehearse beforehand

Practice your presentation before the actual event.

5. Arrive early

Arrange your notes and visual aids. Greet people, learn their names, and smile at them.

6. Relax yourself

Take some water and deep breaths to help yourself relax.

7. Do not begin in a hurry

Take some time to look at the audience, especially people who are familiar to you.

8. Start with an introduction

Introduce yourself and the topic. Try to motivate the audience and get their attention.

9. Think positively

Think that you have prepared well and that you will perform well.

10. Use note-cards

Note-cards help you remember important points and build confidence.

11. End with a summary

Summarize the main points at the end because the audience is likely to remember what is said at the end.

8. Graphic Aids

Graphic aids are visual materials used to support a presentation.

Examples include:

- Photographs
- Pictures
- Pie charts
- Flow charts
- Diagrams
- Graphs
- Line drawings
- Tables
- Handouts
- Boards
- Slides
- Computers
- Videos

- Films

People remember information for longer when they **see it**.

Graphics:

- Make the message more interesting
- Help the audience understand information easily
- Help the audience retain information for longer
- Can communicate information more accurately and quickly than verbal explanation

The audience generally wants to **hear and see** information.

Graphic aids should be selected according to the **style and content** of the presentation. They should be used when something is difficult or vague to explain verbally.

Visual aids should be well-designed and properly used. They should support the content rather than dominate the presentation.

Choosing Graphic Aids

Different graphics are suitable for different audiences.

Small audience:

Flip charts and posters can be useful in a small room.

Medium-sized audience:

Objects, demonstrations, and marker boards can work well when everyone can see them.

Large audience:

Multimedia presentations and films can provide large images that everyone can see.

Things to Check

Make sure:

- The graphic is visible and readable.
- Your body or head does not cover the visual.
- The visual is placed at a suitable level for the audience.
- The audience has enough time to read it.
- All equipment is working properly.

9. Guidelines for Creating Graphic Aids

1. Make the graphic large enough for everyone to see, including people at the back.
2. Do not crowd too many images, words, or numbers onto one graphic.
3. Provide handouts that the audience can refer to later.
4. Make the graphic attractive, but remember that the **message is more important than appearance**.

10. Tips for Using Presentation Software

When using software such as PowerPoint:

1. Use a **landscape layout** for slides because it provides longer lines for text.
2. Give every slide a clear **title or heading**.
3. Use an easy-to-read font such as **Times New Roman**.
4. Use suitable font sizes:
 - Titles: **24–36 points**
 - Text: **18–24 points**
5. Capitalize the first letters of important words in slide titles.
6. In bulleted lists, capitalize only the initial letter of the first word.
7. Keep slides simple and uncluttered. Limit the number of lines to **six or fewer**.
8. Do not use automatic timings for slides. Move slides manually so that you can adjust them according to your speaking speed.

Example of a simple slide:

Benefits of Online Learning

- Flexible learning
- Easy access to resources
- Saves travel time
- Supports remote learning

11. Organizing and Composing Presentations

There are two approaches to organizing a presentation:

1. Direct Approach

In the **direct approach**, the main idea is presented first, followed by details and supporting information.

Example:

"Our company should introduce online training."

Then explain the reasons, evidence, and benefits of online training.

2. Indirect Approach

In the **indirect approach**, supporting details, examples, and evidence are presented first. The main idea is presented afterward.

This approach can be useful when trying to **persuade an audience that may initially be unwilling to support your point**.

Example:

First explain the problems with the current training system, give evidence and examples, and then conclude:

"Therefore, our company should introduce online training."

12. Parts of a Presentation

A presentation can be divided into three main parts:

1. **Introduction**
2. **Body**
3. **Conclusion**

A. Composing the Introduction

The introduction should grab the audience's attention.

You can:

- Use a quotation from a famous person
- Begin with a rhetorical question
- Mention a surprising fact or data
- Tell an anecdote or humorous story

Example using a rhetorical question:

"How much time do we spend using our phones every day?"

This can immediately make the audience think about the topic.

B. Composing the Body

When composing the body:

- Learn the audience's names and address them by name.
- Use **"you"** often.
- Use simple sentence structures.
- Give information that the audience wants or needs.
- Emphasize the main points.
- Stay within the time limit.

C. Composing the Conclusion

The conclusion should:

- Repeat the thesis statement in different words.
- Summarize the key points.

The audience often remembers what is said at the **beginning and end**, so both the introduction and conclusion should be strong.

13. Preparing Notes and Outlines

After planning the presentation, you need to prepare both your **notes and yourself**.

You cannot remember everything from a written paper. Therefore, you should prepare notes or an outline.

You should **not read the presentation word-for-word**. Instead, use your notes as a guide while speaking directly to the audience.

Notes can be prepared using:

- Microsoft PowerPoint
- A word processor
- Paper

Ideas should be organized in an effective order so that the information flows smoothly.

Points to Remember When Preparing Notes

- Do not write complete sentences.
- Leave enough space around the notes.
- Use a large, easy-to-read serif font.
- Put only **one main idea on each note-card**.
- Number the note-cards from beginning to end.

- Keep the structure of the notes uniform.

Example:

Card 1 — Introduction

- Introduce yourself
- Introduce topic
- Ask question

Card 2 — Main Point

- Problem
- Cause
- Example

Card 3 — Conclusion

- Main points
- Final message

14. Personal Appearance

Personal appearance is important during a presentation.

How you look and what you wear should depend on the **context**.

For example:

- Formal dress when speaking to seniors
- Informal dress when speaking to young people in a club

Whatever you wear, you should feel comfortable and confident.

Clothes should be:

- Good quality
- Neat
- Clean
- Ironed

Avoid:

- Very bright colors
- Dazzling jewelry
- Excessive perfume

15. Rehearsing

To give a successful presentation, you should **rehearse using your note-cards and graphics**.

Practice helps build confidence and allows you to identify weaknesses before the actual presentation.

There are several ways to rehearse.

A. Using a Mirror

Practice speaking in front of a mirror using your prepared notes.

You can observe:

- Facial expressions
- Speaking speed
- Body movement
- Hand movements

You become your own audience and can notice problems such as moving your hands too much or using an inappropriate facial expression.

B. Using a Live Audience

Ask family members or friends to listen to your presentation and provide feedback.

You can ask them:

- Did I make enough eye contact?
- Did I speak too fast or too slowly?
- Was the topic clear?
- Did I prove my points?
- Was my voice loud enough?
- Did I pronounce the words correctly?

C. Using an Audio Recorder

Record your speech and listen to it later.

You can check:

- Speaking speed
- Volume
- Pronunciation

- Total time taken

Example:

If you notice that you speak too quickly, you can practice slowing down.

D. Using a Video Recorder

Record your presentation on video and watch it later with a fresh perspective.

You can check:

- Your appearance
- Hand movements
- Body movements
- Speaking speed
- Speaking volume

If you speak too rapidly, you can adjust your speed. You should also make sure your voice is loud enough for everyone to hear without shouting.

16. Presenting

After preparing the presentation, check the environment before you begin.

Checking the Room

Arrive early and:

- Arrange your notes.
- Check that the equipment works.
- Make sure the audience can see and hear properly.
- Check the arrangement of chairs.
- Check the lighting.
- Make sure the room temperature is comfortable.

17. Delivering the Message

When delivering a presentation:

- Begin by introducing yourself and the topic.
- Use suitable facial expressions.
- Maintain eye contact.
- Refer to your notes but do not read them.

- Address people by their names when appropriate.
- Do not keep your hands in your pockets.
- Do not move your hands excessively.
- Do not remain fixed in one place.
- Allow the audience to ask questions.
- End with a summary.

Example of an opening:

"Good morning everyone. My name is Keshav, and today I am going to talk about the importance of cybersecurity for students."

Example of an ending:

"To summarize, we discussed the major risks, common security practices, and ways students can protect their information."

18. Organizing a Group Presentation

Sometimes presentations are made by a group of people working together.

To make a group presentation effective:

A.Divide Roles and Responsibilities

Each member should know:

- What information they are responsible for
- When they will speak
- What part of the presentation they will cover

B.Stay Within the Time Limit

All members should stay within the given time.

C.Introduce the Speakers

All speakers should be introduced either by themselves or by another member.

D.Plan Graphics and Handouts

The group should decide:

- Size and appearance of graphics
- Colors

- Who will distribute handouts
- When handouts will be distributed
- When graphics will be shown
- What notes will be provided

E.Decide When to Answer Questions

The group should decide whether questions will be answered:

- After each speaker's section, or
- After all speakers have finished

19. Lead Presenter

A group presentation should have a **lead presenter** who acts as a facilitator.

The lead presenter:

- Divides the available time among members.
- Keeps questions moving among the presenters.
- Stop speakers who talk for too long.
- Receives requests for additional information.
- Sends necessary information to the audience through email or other communication.

Example:

In a four-person presentation, the lead presenter may give each member five minutes, introduce each speaker, manage the question session, and make sure the entire presentation finishes on time.